

Would You Feel at Home in a Smarthome?



Mitsubishi Electric's smarthome concept



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Like smartphones, smarthomes will also simply creep into your life. When you buy appliances a few years down the line, you will find that they do not make these dumb any more. When buying a doorbell, you will be faced with a choice of surveillance kits. To paint your house, you will find electronics dissolved in the paint, to maintain the temperature. To renovate your house, you will find that doors and windows are no longer simple wooden structures but electronically-reinforced super-smart security personnel. In short, you will no longer find devices that you have to operate, but will end up with a house full of devices that talk to each other, manage themselves and, ultimately, keep you safe and comfortable, too.

The phenomenon has already started setting in with assorted products like smart thermostats, smart power sockets, energy-management systems, connected home monitors, automatic garden sprinklers, connected slow cookers, drones that check

who is at the door and more. While another of this month's stories (page 32) deals with the smarthome framework, popular products and components, here we look at some futuristic research, products and applications.

Not just smarthomes, but a smart neighbourhood, too

In March this year, Google was granted a patent for 'Security Scoring in a Smart-Sensored Home,' which mainly deals with communication and collaboration between sensors embedded in a smarthome. Some of the applications detailed in the patent are really interesting.

You know what best you can do with today's alarm clocks. In the future, a smarter alternative could automatically judge how long it takes you to get ready for work and wake you up accordingly. It would wake you up earlier if it observed traffic on your route or when you have set up a meeting for earlier than usual. Or, it might let you